

Suki the Snail Delivers the Invitation

An original bedtime story for ages 4–7. Reading time: about 4 minutes.



Kids Book Videos



Suki was a tiny garden snail. She lived under a cabbage leaf. Suki had a shiny spiral shell. She carried it everywhere. Slowly. Very slowly. One morning, Suki found a letter. It was an invitation to the Summer Picnic. "Dear friends, come to the meadow at noon!" Suki wanted to deliver it. Her friend Rosie the robin lived across the garden. "I will take it to her!" said Suki. She set off right away. Slide, glide, slide. But snails are very slow. The sun climbed higher. Suki was only halfway there. She felt worried. "I am too slow," she sighed. "The picnic will start without me." She felt sad. Her eyestalks drooped.



Just then, Buster the bumblebee buzzed by. He saw Suki's sad face. "Why so glum, Suki?" asked Buster. "I cannot deliver this in time," said Suki. "I am too slow." Buster landed on her shell. "Slow is not bad," he said. "Slow and steady carries love." "Slow and steady carries love." Suki repeated it softly. "Slow and steady carries love." It became her walking song. "Slow and steady carries love."



Buster had a kind idea. "I will carry the letter for you," he said. "But you come too, slow and steady." Buster zoomed the invitation to Rosie. Buzz! Rosie read it and chirped with joy. Then Buster flew back to Suki. "Hop on!" he said. Suki climbed onto Buster's fuzzy back. They flew over the garden. Whee! Suki had never flown before. The flowers looked like a rainbow quilt. Suki felt amazed. She felt happy. Slow and steady had carried love after all.



Can you fly like Suki and Buster? Spread your arms and buzz: bzzzz! Now land softly, slow and steady. They arrived at the meadow just in time. Rosie was already there. "You made it!" chirped Rosie. She hugged Suki gently. The picnic was wonderful. Strawberry sandwiches. Dandelion tea. Suki shared her lettuce leaf. Everyone shared everything. "Slow and steady carries love," they sang. Suki felt proud. She felt included.



When the sun set, Suki rode home on Buster's back. She curled under her cabbage leaf. Her shell was warm from the day. "Thank you for flying with me," whispered Suki. "Thank you for teaching me slow," buzzed Buster. Suki closed her eyes. She dreamed of flying over rainbow flowers. Buzz, glide, sleep. The garden grew quiet. And Suki slept, slow and cozy.

Moral: *Going slowly is fine when friends help along the way.*

The End